



Smart World

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1 CHARGING 2.0: THE SHIFT TO REVERSE WIRELESS CHARGING

It is possible to mould the idea of using one device to charge another for different kinds of applications that require power, including cellphones and electric vehicles



(Credit: <https://www.androidauthority.com>)

Ever since cellphones were launched, we have been using mostly wired chargers for charging the devices. On several occasions, I, like many others, have wished that there were no cables, or power could be transferred from another charged device in emergency situations, especially while travelling.

Wireless charging is one such innovative idea that manufacturers have tried to break through for years to

compete with each other. Wireless and reverse wireless charging (also called device-to-device charging or wireless power share) have now entered the commercial market.

For wireless charging, wireless chargers and Wireless Power Consortium (WPC) Qi add-ons are necessary. Many new variations to suit different applications are coming up in the wireless charging market. Uncoupled wireless charging can charge through walls

and is suitable for greater distances like in offices and other similar places.

For example, approved by Federal Communications Commission (FCC), US-based company Ossia's Forever Tracking chargers aim to wirelessly charge several Internet of Things (IoT) devices from about five metres, or even further away, using radio frequency (RF). Devices can be managed through the cloud platform of the organisation. Unlike generic wireless chargers, this technology does not require charging pads. Such technologies could cater to the needs of logistics firms during transportation. According to a research report by Market Research Inc., the wireless charging market is expected to grow at a CAGR of more than 35 per cent, from 2019 to 2025.

Wireless phone charging feature can also be seen in cars on a wide scale these days. ZeeHoo wireless charger is one such device.

Despite all these developments, Qi wireless charging is still in its nascent stage and not as fast as quick charge technology. This is gradually expected to change, as seen from Huawei Mate 30 launch, whose reverse wireless charging speed is several times that of pre-existing phones.

In reverse wireless charging, an induction coil is present inside the phone that enables it to act as a charging station and transfer energy via electromagnetic induction to the receiver.